



BERNERA NEWS

A Community Newsletter in association with **The Daily Ceilidh**

As we bring 2022 to a close here at the Bernera News, we give thanks for time with family and friends, and for the support we have received from the community. Year endings are a time for exchanging cards and gifts and festive get-togethers, with friends and family, where we can pause and remember fondly those who are far away or no longer with us, and reminisce about what we have done throughout the year. Even though we have only managed 7 editions this year due to Nat being laid up for so long, we have enjoyed getting them off the printer and out to you all.

This year has still brought some uncertainty and change to us all, but 2023 looks to be more normal. Thanks to our lovely contributors for all the brilliant pieces they have provided during the year. Special thanks to Careen, Colin, Penny and Linne who have all contributed content so unstintingly again, and to our fabulous local distributors, Andrea, Paul, Ben, Claire, Helen, Vicky, Rebecca, Natalie and Sue, for making it possible to get the BN out to the community so efficiently. You have served the community brilliantly again this year and we are grateful for your efforts.

Thanks also to you all for supporting our work this year. The feedback has been most appreciated and we hope you are still enjoying it as much as we enjoy putting it together. We were funded for some of this year by the GBCDT and we are most grateful for their support. If you'd like to get involved and help us deliver the next 12 issues, please get in touch. We wish you all a Merry Christmas and a peaceful new year. Nollaig Chridheil

Julia, Nat & Sam

Contact us at: 01851 600 159
Text/Whatsapp: 07958 549784
Email: hello@thedailyceilidh.co.uk
Or visit us online at:
www.thedailyceilidh.co.uk

LANGABHAT MEDICAL PRACTICE

Due to the Christmas rush, we have had to extend our Prescription turnaround time to 5 working days. As we don't open at Weekends, then the wait time is in essence One Week.

For example if you ordered on Monday 12th December, then collect your prescription on Monday 19th December.

Please also remember the Practice will be open on the Weds, Thu and Fri of Christmas Week and New Year Week, therefore, prescriptions can be ordered and collected on these dates.

Day	Leurbost	Paicr	Bernera	Uig	Carloway	Borve
Mon 26th	Closed	Closed	Closed	Closed	Closed	Closed
Tues 27th	Closed	Closed	Closed	Closed	Closed	Closed
Wed 28th	8am-6pm	10am-1pm	10am-3pm	10am-5pm	8am-6pm	Closed
Thurs 29th	8am-6pm	Closed	Closed	Closed	Closed	8am-5pm
Fri 30th	8am-6pm	9:30am-4pm	8am-1pm	9:30am-3pm	9am-6pm	8am-5pm
Day	Leurbost	Paicr	Bernera	Uig	Carloway	Borve
Mon 2nd	Closed	Closed	Closed	Closed	Closed	Closed
Tues 3rd	Closed	Closed	Closed	Closed	Closed	Closed
Wed 4th	8am-6pm	10am-1pm	10am-3pm	10am-5pm	8am-6pm	Closed
Thurs 5th	8am-6pm	Closed	Closed	Closed	Closed	8am-5pm
Fri 6th	8am-6pm	9:30am-4pm	8am-1pm	9:30am-3pm	9am-6pm	8am-5pm



SEW BERNERA

A free, weekly, fun sewing group, being held on Thursday evenings 6:30 till 8:30 in the Bernera Hall. Join us to share skills and have a laugh. Join the facebook group at [facebook.com/groups/sewbernera](https://www.facebook.com/groups/sewbernera) to find out more or get in touch with Virginia 07460 467 721 or Julia 07894 516 609



HOGMANAY AT THE HALL

Come along and celebrate the new year at the Bernera Hogmanay party!
Monday 2nd Jan 2023 - Bernera Community Hall, open from 8pm
Bring your own bottle.
All Welcome.



ELIZABETH RETIRES



Back on the 8th of April 1999 Elizabeth Macleod was asked by Noreen Maciver if she would like to work as a guide in the newly constructed Iron Age House replica at Bosta Beach for a few weeks. Now after 23 years Elizabeth has decided it is time to retire and the 2022 season has been her last.

Elizabeth worked at the Iron Age House five days a week from May to September for 21 seasons; Covid closed the house for two seasons, and has welcomed thousands of people from all round the world to our remote island and tell them stories about the house and people who lived in the area around 1300 years ago. Having spent so much time in the house she has had a unique insight that into how the people may have lived in and used the house, and many of the assumptions made by the archaeologists at the time of the Bosta dig in 1996 she has either confirmed or more often conclude something different. For example the archaeologists called the small second room 'The women's work room', well Elizabeth tried to work in that room and

found it too cold and dark to be able to work in, especially when the fire and space was in the main room. Her conclusion is that the second room was in fact the food store where enough food could be stored for the family of about 12 for the long winter months.

Elizabeth also experimented at the house and made her own pottery from local materials and sun dried it, smoked different foods over the peat fire, dried fish and meat in the sun, drop spun wool and made rope from grass found outside, as well as generally get to know how the house was set up. This has been living and experimental archaeology at its best.

As said before Elizabeth welcomed people from all over the world and it you look on trip advisor you will find many comments stating how wonderful she was and brought much to the experience of visitors to the house and Bernera.



2019 was the busiest year at the house with 5013 visitors and in 2022 welcomed 4222, a drop of only 16% when the average across Scotland is 20% down. Many visitors come by coach from cruise ships, about 12% of all visitors, but the majority are still independent holiday makers, and some locals, who come to Bernera either because of the Iron Age House and Bosta beach or find it when they get here. It is justified to say that the Iron Age House is the main attraction on Bernera and that it has been Elizabeth that has made it so.

Over the last few summers the house has also been opened on a Saturday with other volunteer guides, who have all learnt from Elizabeth and use her experience and knowledge when explaining the House. Elizabeth is going to be missed and we are all sad that she has made this decision but at the same time are happy for her and thankful that she has dedicated so much time to the Bosta Iron Age House.

The trustees are looking to find a new guide for the 2023 season and the opening of the Iron Age House will go ahead as normal, after all there are already 12 tour groups booked in for next year.

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost



CHURCH QUIZ NIGHT

Thank You to everyone who supported the Big Quiz Night and helped to make it possible, including all those who made it out on a wet and windy night.

We raised over £300 towards the fight against global poverty.

Well Done!

GLUTEN FREE CHOCOLATE CHIP BROWNIE

Ingredients:

175g butter or margarine
175g dark chocolate
150g light brown sugar
3 eggs
1 tsp vanilla extract
15g cocoa powder
1 tsp baking powder
150g ground almonds
200g chocolate chips

Method:

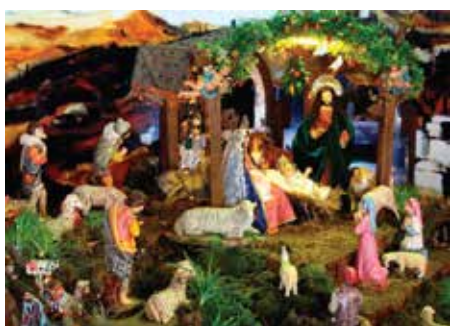
1. Melt butter or margarine, chocolate & sugar in a large pan over a medium heat. Stir until sugar has dissolved.
2. Cool for 10 minutes.
3. Whisk in eggs, mixing well.
4. Stir in vanilla extract.
5. Add cocoa powder, baking powder & ground almonds mixing well.
6. Fold in chocolate chips.
7. Bake at 180°C for 40 mins.
8. Cut into squares when cool.
9. ENJOY with ice-cream or with a strùpag.



Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost



ÀM NA NOLLAIGE



'S e an Dublachd s th'ann mu thràth, am mìos as fheàrr leam bho bha mi nam nighean bheag, oir tha e à ciallachadh adh gum bi na Nollaig a'tighinn a dh'aighgearr.

Tha mi air a bhith a'smaoineachadh air am na Nollaige a chuir mi seachad an seo ann an Alba, San Ostair agus ann am Pearù

Tha iomadh cuimhe sona agam air an Nollaig nuair a bha mi a' fas suas an an Siorrachd Dhùn Phris.

Bha a h-uile duine ann an deagh shunnd. Agus dh'iomlaid muinntir a'bhaile air fad cairtean. Sgeadaich sinn na seòmraichean le geugan cuilinn agus durcain agus ceanglaichean paiper.

Anns an sgoil bhiodh sinn ag eisteachd ris an sgeulachd na Nollaige agus à seinn laoidhean.

Bha sinn cuideachd air bhioran a feitheamh ris à phàrtaidh anns an talla, an-comhnaidh tachartas sònraichte.

Chòrd e rinn a bhith a'cluich geam annan agus a' seinn. Bha biadh gu leòr ann agus ged a bha e fuar a-muigh, bha sinne toilichte ag ithe rèiteag agus slaman-milis.

An uairsin chruinnicheadh sinn timcheall air craobh mhòr na Nollaige, agus ri solas nan coinnlean deigheadh am Bodach na Nollaige le tiodhlacan is orainsearan.

Nuair a chaidh sinn dhan Ostair a tha dùthaich chaitligeach, bha sinn à fuireach ann am baile beag cuideachd. An sin chunnaic mi blàth-fhleasg Advent à chiad turas. Tha àbhaist ann "A'lorg fasgadh". Anns a'mhios roimh Nollaig thèid teaghlach gu taigh nàbaidh le dealbh na h-òighe Moire, a'lorg fasgadh.

An sin bidh iad a'deanamh ùrnaigh agus à seinn sailm agus laoidhean le cheile agus às deidh laimhe ghabh iad balgam is briosaidean.

continued on page 4

continued from page 3



Dh'fhuirich an dealbh ann gus an ath fheasgar nuair a bheirear e gu nabadhean eile. Air Oichde Nollaig bidh iad ag ithe iasg : carbhan.

Às deidh sin gheibh a h-uile duine no tiodhlacan a tha fon chraibh Nollaige. Ach chan e am Bodach na Nollaige a tha gan toirt, ach an Leanabh Criosd. Mar as trice bidh tòrr sneáhd ann, ach coisichidh mòran dhaoine dhan Eaglais aig meadhan oichdhe.

Nollaig ann am Pearù --Nollaig as t-samrach!

Bha sin rudeigin duilich is neo-àbhaisteach dhomhsa an toiseach. B'e am poinsetta an lus a chitheadh sibh anns a h-uile h-àite. Airson grunn bhliadhnu- ichean chan fhaca mi craobhan Nollige sam bith gus an do nochd craobhan fuadain anns na bùthan agus fhair sinn tè bhreàgha sa bhad.

Bha seallaidhean "Nativity" anns a h-uile taigh, Eaglais, bùth neo àite a buinneagan Bruisealach. Agus tha panettone le tèoclad leth pàirt chudromach de aoibhneas na Nollaige. Ged a thai an aon fhèill, à cuimhneachadh Breith Josa, that tòrr àbhaistean is tradiseanan eadar- dh'èalaichte anns gach dùthaich.

Nollaig Chridheil dhuibh uile.

Linne NicLeòid
Dun Innes



WINTER GARDENING

I love a winter garden, once the leaves have fallen, turning into insect hiding piles of leaves, I can look at the bare bones of the garden and see what needs to be done. Is there any damage to plants, what blew over or was violently torn off any trees by the October gales? What is now swamped in the November rain storms?

What, in effect, needs tidying up or moving from what is now a new swampy area?

The gorse is bravely flowering, and I've started cutting back the roses for the next spring and to inspect for any fungal diseases like Black spot. Now is the time to get on in the garden if you can. I've two more beds to tidy, one full of Hebes, Wegeila and Oleria which needs a severe cut back, though the rose in there has been flowering well into December.

The other bed needing some work is a bed in my back yard, developed during lockdown. It is a raised bed containing all the plum trees and a Cherry which were not doing well in the poly tunnels, plus some David Austen, and Willow Glen roses. I need to plant four more roses in there and weed out all the creeping buttercups. I shall leave some nettles in there just a few for the butterflies and moths which lay their eggs on nettles.

Such a useful plant Nettles, use in spring as an early source of vitamin C, steam young nettle like spinach. Use dried as a tea, most refreshing. It's a bit like the Dandelion, you can cut and use young Dandelion leaves in a salad, gives a bitter tinge like chicory, or use in soups. Some people pull the roots out and scrub clean and dry for making a coffee substitute. I love the Dandelion flowers, the first feed for the bees. So I keep mine rooted.



I've lots of Willow out the front, cut back from willow wind shelters if people need some, do contact me for cuttings. Or just come and help yourselves from the pile. The best time to put in cuttings is from January to the end of March, just before the sap starts to rise. I have grown Hebes from cuttings and as I shall be cutting them back too, I shall leave a few out if anyone wants them. This is hardy white flowering Hebe.

Wrap up warm as it is getting much colder, remember gardening is not only good for the soul, it is good exercise too.

Penny Spinks
Hacklete



COLOURING IN FUN

We've added a colouring page in addition to our usual quizzes and word searches. Many of you have children or will have younger family visiting, so get them involved.

Share pictures of your/their finished creations via **Whatsapp** or the **Daily Ceilidh facebook page**, where you will also find links to copies of the Bernera News, as well as a link to download the Christmas colouring page, and a few others too.

If you'd like extra copies delivered, please let us know by ringing or texting Julia on **07894 516 609**.



JESUS IS THE REASON FOR THE SEASON

A survey concluded that 33% of those questioned, stated, that of all the persons mentioned in the Christmas story, they identified the most with the shepherds.

The shepherds were average, ordinary people and were invited to see the birth of the King of Kings.

Christmas is a season when ordinary and extraordinary people, rich and poor, important and not so important (at least in the eyes of man), are invited to reflect upon a moment when His story became part of their and our history.

A moment when God opened his heart and revealed the identity of the amazing gift he was sending to bless the whole of humankind with.

A gift so glorious it caused the angel of Lord to cry out, ***"Do not be afraid, for behold, I bring you good tidings of great joy which will be to all people. For there is born to you this day in the city of David a Savior"***.

What a wonderful gift God has given to all who will receive, Jesus as Saviour and Lord.

May you have a truly, blessed Christ-centred Christmas and a grace-filled, New Year.

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



FORAGE



Forage, the Croft Honesty shop in Kirkibost, is open to pick up your forgotten Christmas goodies, last minute purchases and more this festive season. We will be open throughout to keep you topped up and ready for any unexpected visitors.

We have a range of festive treats, including cheese, crackers and Hebridean Charcuterie, as well as all the usual bits and bobs, ranging from pastry to kindling. If you need something picking up or a hamper for a gift, give us a call and we will add you to our deliveries.

Text Julia on **07894516609**



GENERAL KNOWLEDGE QUIZ

1. Michael Bentine was in this comedic show
2. Russian providence surrounded by the EU
3. A prime number can be divided only by 1 and what else
4. Hottest planet in the solar system
5. Christopher Reeve, Henry Cavil and Dean Cain were all
6. Mountain an Ullapool ferry was once named for
7. Known as the granite city
8. 11th Century year of three kings of England
9. The most prolific Scots surname beginning Mac
10. Author of Animal Farm
11. Home of the main Roman Gods
12. The Great Skua is also known as a
13. Before the Edwardians were the
14. American for a car bonnet
15. Calfskin used for writing
16. Calluna Vulgaris is better known as
17. Fred Basset first appeared in which paper
18. Who makes the Cream Egg
19. A Chinese orange
20. It is said that 8 out of 10 cats prefer
21. The horror book The Stand was written by
22. Rock duo who pioneered the California sound
23. The bad brother of Able
24. UK's longest running soap opera
25. The bird with a Swiss clock
26. Saint founder of Iona Abbey
27. The highest building in Paris
28. Element with lowest Atomic number of 1 is
29. She sang of Heathcliff in Wuthering Heights
30. The National Railway Museum is in this city

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost

